

Getting VetPath into official VA and DoW channels

There is no single application that makes a website "official." What exists instead is a set of real doors: distribution networks that push resources to millions of veterans, vetted federal directories, local boards, and the transition classroom itself. Three are open to us today. The rest have gates, and one of those gates runs on a two-year clock we have not started.

August 14, 2026 Every channel below verified against its official source

Start with what "official" actually means

The VA does not endorse outside websites. It says so directly: inclusion of an organization in a VA directory **does not constitute approval or endorsement** by VA or the United States Government. Any pitch built around implied endorsement will fail, and claiming it would put us on the wrong side of the line we have drawn on every page of the site.

What the VA and the Department of War *do* offer is **distribution** - getting a trustworthy resource in front of transitioning service members through channels they already read. That is the winnable goal, and it is worth far more to us than a logo.

On the name: Executive Order 14347 (September 2025) made "Department of War" a secondary title. The Department of Defense remains the legal name, since only Congress can change a statutory title. In practice both appear - SkillBridge now brands itself DoW SkillBridge. Use "Department of War (DoW)" in correspondence and nobody will blink either way.

THE DOORS, RANKED BY WHAT THEY RETURN

Four channels open to us now

VetResources Community Network

[OPEN NOW](#)

The VA Veterans Experience Office runs this network for veteran-serving organizations. Membership is open by application, not by invitation, and it is the single highest-leverage move available to us.

What membership actually buys: the ability to publish our resources in the VetResources newsletter, which goes to **over 17 million veterans weekly**; to post our outreach events on the official VA Outreach and Events page; and to publish posts on VA News under the #VetResources tag. Members also get monthly Connect sessions and access to subgroups.

- 1 Register for a consult** with the Veterans Experience Office through the VRCN registration page. This is the intake step - a conversation, not a paper application.
- 2 Bring the site itself to the consult.** Our strongest asset is that every number on VetPath links to an official source. That is exactly the standard these programs vet for.
- 3 Join the Community of Practice** once accepted, then start with an events post before attempting a newsletter placement.

National Resource Directory

[OPEN NOW](#)

A tri-agency directory run jointly by the Departments of Defense, Veterans Affairs, and Labor - the closest thing that exists to an official list of vetted resources for service members and families. Any organization or individual may submit a resource for review.

Why it is worth the paperwork: listings are verified through a documented vetting process and re-checked annually against the directory's participation policy. Being in it is a credential we can point to in every other conversation on this page.

- 1 Read the participation policy first** and confirm we meet each criterion before submitting. Resources must be accessible and relevant to service members, veterans, families, and the providers who serve them.
- 2 Submit through [nrd.gov](#)**, tagging the audiences and subject topics that match our tools - transition, employment, education, housing.
- 3 Calendar the annual re-verification** so a listing is never lost to an unanswered email.

Community Veterans Engagement Boards

[OPEN NOW](#)

Local boards, roughly 160 of them nationally, where veterans, service providers, and civic leaders work on gaps in their own community. They are supported by the VA's Veterans Experience Office but operated locally, and they are explicitly open to everyone - veterans and service providers alike.

This is Frank's home-field advantage. Boards are where VSO staff, county veteran service officers, and VA facility outreach people are physically in the same room. One good relationship here beats a hundred cold emails.

- 1 Find the nearest board.** I could not confirm a dedicated DFW board from public listings, so start by asking VA North Texas Health Care System's outreach staff which board covers our area.
- 2 Work the Dallas Veteran Affairs Commission in parallel** - it is the city's own veteran board and a direct line into municipal referral paths.
- 3 If no local board exists, consider starting one.** The VA publishes a CVEB playbook for exactly this, and founding one would put VetPath at the center of the regional table.

The transition classroom (TAP)

[OPEN NOW](#)

The Transition Assistance Program is an interagency effort - Defense, Labor, Education, VA, Homeland Security, plus SBA and OPM. Its curriculum is federally mandated and not something an outside organization gets added to. But the program explicitly recognizes a surrounding layer of *community resources* delivered by local government, industry, and nonprofits. That layer is where we belong.

The realistic target is the handout table and the referral habits of two specific roles: installation Transition Assistance staff, and the VA TAP Benefits Advisors posted at many installations. Both spend their days pointing people somewhere.

- 1 **Identify the nearest installations** and their transition offices - for North Texas that means starting with NAS Fort Worth JRB.
- 2 **Lead with the printed one-pager, not the URL.** These offices hand paper to people in a classroom. We already have the piece, and it is built for exactly this.
- 3 **Ask for a five-minute demo slot** with the VA Benefits Advisor rather than a curriculum change. The advisor is the decision-maker who matters.

NOT OUR DOOR

DoD SkillBridge comes up constantly in these conversations, but it is a program for employers hosting transitioning service members as interns - not a listing channel for resources. It also requires an organization to have existed three years, with applications only in the fall and spring windows. Worth knowing so we can speak to it; not worth pursuing.

BLOCKED UNTIL WE DECIDE SOMETHING

The two channels with real gates

Texas Veterans Commission grants

GATED · TWO-YEAR CLOCK

The Fund for Veterans' Assistance awards reimbursement grants to organizations providing direct services to Texas veterans and their families. It is the most realistic money on this page and the reason the entity question is now urgent rather than philosophical.

THE GATE, PRECISELY

A 501(c)(3) must have existed **longer than two years** measured from the effective date on its IRS determination letter. Nothing accelerates that clock. Every month we delay filing is a month added to the date we first become eligible. Note that 501(c)(19) veterans posts and Texas chapters of 501(c)(4) veterans service organizations are eligible too, which may matter depending on how we structure.

- 1 **Decide the entity question with Frank** - the nonprofit fork we have discussed. This is the decision that unblocks everything below it.
- 2 **File promptly once decided.** The filing date, not the launch date, starts the eligibility clock.
- 3 **Use the waiting period** to build the service-delivery numbers these grants ask for. Pilot data from Frank's network is exactly that evidence.

Secretary's Center for Strategic Partnerships

LONG HORIZON

The VA office that builds formal partnerships with industry and nonprofits around the Secretary's priority initiatives. This is the genuine top of the funnel - and it works through established relationships and demonstrated scale, not an online form.

Treat it as a destination, not a starting point. The credible path runs through everything above: a National Resource Directory listing, an active VRCN membership, real usage numbers, and a local board relationship are the evidence that makes this conversation possible in a year or two.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

What has to stay true for any of this to survive vetting

- **Never touch claims preparation.** The VA's Office of General Counsel accredits the attorneys, claims agents, and VSO representatives permitted to help prepare, present, or prosecute a benefits claim. General information about benefits is fine. Advice tied to a specific person's specific application is not, and crossing that line without accreditation is a legal problem, not a branding one. VetPath is built on the correct side of it - keep it there.
- **Never imply endorsement.** No VA or DoW seals, no "official partner" language, no government-adjacent design cues. Directory inclusion is not endorsement and must never be described as such.
- **Every figure keeps its source link.** This is already our practice and it is the single thing that will carry us through the NRD vetting process. It is also the reason we can be honest about being a private site rather than a government one.
- **The sponsored-connections plan needs sequencing thought.** We removed the "no ads, no selling" promises so that paid partner introductions stay open. That is a fine business decision, but it becomes a question these vetting processes may ask. Have the answer ready: introductions are labeled, veteran-initiated, and never a condition of using the free tools.

SEQUENCING

What to do, in order

THIS MONTH

Register for the VRCN consult and submit to the NRD

Both are free, neither requires nonprofit status, and together they establish the credential record every later conversation depends on.

THIS MONTH

Frank makes two calls

VA North Texas outreach staff, to find the right local engagement board; and NAS Fort Worth JRB's transition office, to ask what it takes to get a resource sheet on the table.

NEXT 60 DAYS**Settle the entity question**

The two-year eligibility clock on Texas grant money does not start until the IRS determination letter is dated. This is the only item on the page where waiting has a measurable cost.

**AFTER THE
PILOT****Convert usage into evidence**

The site already records which outreach channel brought each person in. After Frank's pilot we will have real numbers - the thing every one of these programs asks for and most applicants cannot produce.

YEAR TWO**Approach strategic partnerships**

With a directory listing, network membership, local relationships, and usage data in hand, the conversation at the top of the funnel becomes credible.

SOURCES

- [VetResources Community Network - VA Veterans Experience Office](#)
- [National Resource Directory \(DoD / VA / DOL\)](#)
- [Community Veterans Engagement Boards - VA](#)
- [VA TAP Benefits Advisors](#)
- [Transition Assistance Program - Department of Labor](#)
- [DoW SkillBridge - industry providers](#)
- [Texas Veterans Commission - Fund for Veterans' Assistance](#)
- [Secretary's Center for Strategic Partnerships - VA](#)
- [VA Office of General Counsel - accreditation](#)
- [Dallas Veteran Affairs Commission](#)